Unit-5: Probabilistic Reasoning

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5.1 Introduction to Probabilistic Reasoning

In many real-world situations, information is **incomplete, uncertain, or ambiguous**. Artificial Intelligence systems must still make decisions even when they do not have perfect information.

Probabilistic reasoning is a method used in AI to **handle uncertainty by using probability theory**. It allows AI systems to estimate the likelihood of events and make decisions based on available evidence.

This approach is widely used in:

- medical diagnosis
- speech recognition
- robotics
- recommendation systems

Overview

Concept	**Meaning**
Uncertainty in AI	lack of complete or accurate information
Probabilistic reasoning	reasoning using probability
Deterministic reasoning	reasoning with certain outcomes
Probabilistic reasoning	reasoning with uncertain outcomes

1. Concept of Uncertainty in AI

Meaning : Uncertainty refers to situations where the AI system **does not have complete knowledge or the available information may be unreliable**.

Real-world environments often contain uncertainty because:

- data may be incomplete

- sensors may produce errors
- information may be ambiguous

Example
Medical diagnosis:
Symptoms:
fever
cough
Possible diseases:

- flu
- cold
- infection

The AI system cannot be **100% certain** which disease the patient has. It must estimate the **probability of each disease**.

Sources of Uncertainty in AI

Source	Explanation
Incomplete data	missing information
Noisy data	inaccurate measurements
Ambiguity	multiple interpretations
Dynamic environments	changing conditions

Example of Uncertainty
Weather prediction:
Observation: Dark clouds in sky
Possible outcomes:

- rain
- no rain

The system cannot be completely sure, so it assigns a probability.
Example: Probability of rain = 70%

2. Need for Probabilistic Reasoning
Traditional logical reasoning assumes that **statements are either completely true or completely false**.
However, real-world problems often involve **degrees of belief rather than absolute truth**.
Probabilistic reasoning helps AI systems make **best possible decisions under uncertainty**.

Why Probabilistic Reasoning is Needed

Reason	Explanation
handle uncertainty	real-world data often incomplete
manage risk	estimate likelihood of events
combine evidence	update beliefs using new information
improve decision making	choose most probable outcome

Example
Spam email detection.
Evidence: Email contains suspicious words
The system calculates probability: P(spam | suspicious words) = 0.85
The AI concludes that the email is **likely spam**.

Example: Autonomous Vehicles
Sensors detect objects on road.
However:

- sensors may fail
- lighting conditions may affect detection

The AI system calculates probabilities to determine whether an object is:

- pedestrian
- vehicle
- obstacle

3. Deterministic vs Probabilistic Reasoning
There are two main reasoning approaches used in AI systems.

Deterministic Reasoning
Meaning : Deterministic reasoning assumes that the system has **complete and certain information**.
Each action produces a **fixed and predictable result**.

Example
Mathematical equation: 2 + 3 = 5
The result is always correct and certain.

Example in AI
Rule:
IF temperature > 100°C
THEN water boils
This rule always produces the same outcome.

Characteristics of Deterministic Reasoning

Feature	Explanation
certain results	outcome always predictable
exact knowledge	information completely known
logical rules	strict true/false conditions

Probabilistic Reasoning
Meaning : Probabilistic reasoning deals with **uncertain or incomplete information** by assigning probabilities to events.
Instead of saying something is **true or false**, it measures **how likely it is to be true**.

Example
Weather forecast: Probability of rain = 60%
The system estimates the likelihood rather than giving a definite answer.

Characteristics of Probabilistic Reasoning

Feature	Explanation
handles uncertainty	incomplete data
uses probability	likelihood of events
flexible reasoning	multiple possible outcomes

Comparison: Deterministic vs Probabilistic Reasoning

Feature	Deterministic Reasoning	Probabilistic Reasoning
certainty	exact outcomes	uncertain outcomes
knowledge	complete knowledge	incomplete knowledge
representation	true or false	probability values
example	mathematical calculations	weather prediction

4. Why AI Needs Probability to Handle Uncertainty

Real-world problems are rarely deterministic.

AI systems must deal with:

- noisy sensor data
- incomplete observations
- uncertain environments

Probability provides a **mathematical framework for dealing with uncertainty**.

Role of Probability in AI

Probability helps AI systems:

Function	Description
estimate likelihood	probability of events
update beliefs	adjust predictions with new evidence
combine multiple sources	integrate different observations
make optimal decisions	choose most probable outcome

Example: Medical Diagnosis

Symptoms:

fever

cough

fatigue

Possible diseases:

Disease	Probability
Flu	0.6
COVID	0.3
Cold	0.1

The AI system chooses the **most probable diagnosis**.

Example: Speech Recognition

User says a sentence.

Due to noise, the system calculates probability of words.

Example:

Word	Probability
"cat"	0.6
"cap"	0.3
"car"	0.1

The system selects the **most probable word**.

Applications of Probabilistic Reasoning in AI

Application	Example
Medical diagnosis	disease prediction

Robotics	sensor uncertainty
Natural language processing	speech recognition
Recommendation systems	product recommendations

Summary

Concept	Meaning
Uncertainty	incomplete or unreliable information
Probabilistic reasoning	reasoning using probability
Deterministic reasoning	reasoning with certain outcomes
Probability in AI	helps handle uncertain environments

Probabilistic reasoning allows AI systems to **make intelligent decisions even when the available information is incomplete or uncertain**.

5.2 Probability Theory Basics

Topics include:

- random events
- sample space
- probability rules
- conditional probability.

Probability Theory Basics: Probability theory provides the **mathematical foundation for probabilistic reasoning in Artificial Intelligence**. It allows AI systems to measure uncertainty and estimate the likelihood of events.

Using probability, AI systems can:

- predict outcomes
- update beliefs when new evidence appears
- make decisions under uncertainty

Key concepts in probability theory include:

- random events
- sample space
- probability rules
- conditional probability

Overview of Probability Concepts

Concept	Meaning
Random Event	event whose outcome is uncertain
Sample Space	set of all possible outcomes
Probability Rules	mathematical laws governing probabilities
Conditional Probability	probability of event given another event

1. Random Events

Meaning: A **random event** is an event whose outcome **cannot be predicted with certainty before it occurs**.

The result depends on chance or uncertain conditions.

Example: Tossing a coin.

Possible outcomes:

Heads

Tails

The result cannot be known before the coin is tossed.

More Examples

Experiment	Random Event
Tossing a coin	getting heads
Rolling a die	getting number 6
Weather prediction	rain tomorrow

Each outcome occurs **with a certain probability**.

Types of Events

Type	Description	Example
Simple event	single outcome	rolling a 3
Compound event	combination of outcomes	rolling even number
Independent event	events not affecting each other	two coin tosses
Dependent event	one event affects another	drawing cards without replacement

2. Sample Space

Meaning: The **sample space** is the **set of all possible outcomes of an experiment**.
It is usually represented by the symbol: S

Example: Coin Toss
Sample space: S = {Heads, Tails}

Example: Rolling a Die
Sample space: S = {1,2,3,4,5,6}
Each outcome belongs to the sample space.

Example: Two Coin Tosses
Sample space: S = {HH, HT, TH, TT}
Possible events:

Event	Meaning
HH	both heads
HT	head then tail
TH	tail then head
TT	both tails

Event Representation
An **event** is a subset of the sample space.
Example:
Sample space: S = {1,2,3,4,5,6}
Event: E = {2,4,6}
Meaning: rolling an **even number**.

3. Probability Rules

Probability measures **how likely an event is to occur**.
The probability value lies between:
$0 \le P(E) \le 1$
Where:

- **0** → impossible event

- **1** → certain event

Basic Probability Formula
Probability of event **E**:
$P(E) = \text{Number of favorable outcomes} / \text{Total number of outcomes}$

Example
Rolling a die.
Event: E = getting 4
Total outcomes: 6
Probability: $P(E) = 1/6$

Important Probability Rules
Rule 1: Probability Range
Probability always lies between 0 and 1.
$0 \le P(E) \le 1$

Rule 2: Complement Rule
Probability of event not occurring:
$P(\text{not } E) = 1 - P(E)$
Example:
Probability of rain: $P(\text{rain}) = 0.7$
Probability of no rain: $P(\text{no rain}) = 1 - 0.7 = 0.3$

Rule 3: Addition Rule
Probability of either event A or B occurring:
$P(A \cup B) = P(A) + P(B) - P(A \cap B)$
Where:
- **$P(A \cap B)$** is probability that both events occur.

Example
Probability of drawing a **king or queen** from deck.
Events:
A = king
B = queen
Probability:
$P(A) = 4/52$
$P(B) = 4/52$
Total probability: $P(A \cup B) = 8/52$

Rule 4: Multiplication Rule
Probability that **two events occur together**:
$P(A \cap B) = P(A) \times P(B)$
(for independent events)

Example: Two coin tosses.
Probability of **two heads**: $P(HH) = 1/2 \times 1/2 = 1/4$

4. Conditional Probability

Meaning: Conditional probability measures the probability of an event occurring **given that another event has already occurred**.
It is represented as: P(A | B)
Meaning: Probability of **A given B**.

Conditional Probability Formula
P(A | B) = P(A ∩ B) / P(B)
Where:

- **P(A ∩ B)** = probability of both A and B occurring
- **P(B)** = probability of event B

Example
Suppose we draw a card from a deck.
Event:
A = card is king
B = card is face card
Face cards: 12
Kings: 4
Conditional probability: P(king | face card) = 4/12 = 1/3

Example in AI : Medical diagnosis.
Event: Disease = Flu
Symptom = Fever
Conditional probability: P(Flu | Fever)
Meaning: Probability of flu given that the patient has fever.
This concept forms the basis for **Bayes' Theorem**, which we will study next.

Importance of Probability Theory in AI
Probability theory allows AI systems to:

Function	Example
estimate likelihood	disease probability
combine evidence	medical tests
update beliefs	Bayesian inference
make predictions	weather forecasting

Applications in AI

Application	Example
Medical diagnosis	disease prediction
Robotics	sensor uncertainty
Natural language processing	speech recognition
Machine learning	probabilistic models

Summary

Concept	Meaning
Random Event	uncertain outcome
Sample Space	set of possible outcomes
Probability Rules	mathematical laws of probability
Conditional Probability	probability given another event

Probability theory provides the **mathematical basis for reasoning under uncertainty**, which is essential for intelligent decision-making in AI systems.

5.3 Bayes' Theorem : This is one of the **most important concepts in probabilistic AI and machine learning**.

Bayes' Theorem : Bayes' Theorem is one of the most important concepts in probabilistic reasoning and Artificial Intelligence. It provides a mathematical method to **update the probability of a hypothesis when new evidence is observed**.

In simple terms, Bayes' theorem helps an AI system **revise its belief about an event based on new data**.

It is widely used in:

- medical diagnosis
- spam detection
- machine learning
- prediction systems

Overview

Concept	Meaning
Bayes' Theorem	formula for updating probabilities
Prior Probability	probability before observing evidence
Likelihood	probability of evidence given hypothesis
Posterior Probability	updated probability after evidence

1. Bayes' Rule Formula

Bayes' theorem is expressed mathematically as:

P(H | E) = [P(E | H) × P(H)] / P(E)

Where:

Symbol	Meaning
P(H	E)
P(E	H)
P(H)	Prior probability
P(E)	Probability of evidence

Explanation of Bayes Formula

Component	Meaning
Prior Probability	belief before observing evidence
Likelihood	probability of evidence if hypothesis is true
Evidence Probability	overall probability of evidence
Posterior Probability	updated belief after evidence

2. Prior Probability

Meaning : Prior probability represents the probability of an event **before observing new evidence**.

It is the **initial belief** about a hypothesis.

Representation

P(H)

Where **H** is the hypothesis.

Example

Suppose:

- 1% of people have a certain disease.

Prior probability: P(Disease) = 0.01
This is the probability **before any medical test is performed**.

3. Likelihood
Meaning : Likelihood is the probability of observing the evidence assuming that the hypothesis is true.

Representation
P(E | H)
Meaning: Probability of evidence **E** given hypothesis **H**.

Example
Medical test: If a person has the disease, the test is positive **95% of the time**.
P(Positive | Disease) = 0.95
This represents the **likelihood**.

4. Posterior Probability
Meaning : Posterior probability is the probability of the hypothesis **after observing the evidence**.
It is the updated belief calculated using Bayes' theorem.

Representation : P(H | E)
Meaning: Probability of hypothesis **H** given evidence **E**.

Example
Suppose:

- a person tests positive.

We want to calculate:
P(Disease | Positive)
This is the **posterior probability**.

5. Evidence Probability
Evidence probability represents the **overall probability of observing the evidence**.
Representation: P(E)
Example:
Probability of getting a positive test result.
This includes both:

- true positive
- false positive

Example of Bayes' Theorem
Suppose:

Information	Value
Disease probability	0.01
Test accuracy	0.95
False positive rate	0.05

We want to calculate: P(Disease | Positive)
Using Bayes formula: P(H | E) = [P(E | H) × P(H)] / P(E)

Calculation: P(Disease | Positive) = (0.95 × 0.01) / P(Positive)
This gives the **updated probability after observing the test result**.

Concept: Updating Belief Using Evidence
Bayes' theorem is mainly used to **update beliefs when new information is obtained**.
Process: Initial belief → observe evidence → update belief

Bayesian Reasoning Flow
Prior Knowledge
↓
Observe Evidence
↓
Apply Bayes Theorem
↓
Posterior Probability
The posterior probability becomes the **new belief**.

Example: Email Spam Detection
Prior probability: P(Spam) = 0.4
Evidence: Email contains suspicious words.
Likelihood: P(Word | Spam) = 0.8
Using Bayes theorem, the system calculates: P(Spam | Word)
If probability is high, the email is classified as **spam**.

Example: Weather Prediction
Prior probability: P(Rain) = 0.3
Evidence: Dark clouds observed.
Likelihood: P(Clouds | Rain) = 0.9
Bayesian reasoning updates the probability of rain.

Applications of Bayes' Theorem in AI

Application	Example
Medical diagnosis	disease probability
Spam filtering	email classification
Speech recognition	word prediction
Machine learning	Bayesian classifiers

Advantages of Bayesian Reasoning

Advantage	Explanation
handles uncertainty	probabilistic reasoning
updates knowledge	integrates new evidence
mathematically sound	based on probability theory

Limitations

Limitation	Explanation
requires probability values	may be difficult to estimate
complex calculations	large datasets increase complexity

Summary

Concept	Meaning
Bayes' Theorem	formula for updating probability
Prior Probability	initial belief
Likelihood	probability of evidence given hypothesis
Posterior Probability	updated belief after evidence

Bayes' theorem is a powerful tool in AI that enables systems to **learn from evidence and update predictions dynamically**.

5.4 Certainty Factors and Rule-Based Systems : which explains how **expert systems manage uncertainty when probabilities are not available**.

Certainty Factors: In many AI systems, especially **expert systems**, knowledge may be **uncertain or incomplete**. Sometimes it is difficult to assign exact probabilities to events. To handle this type of uncertainty, **certainty factors (CF)** are used.

A **certainty factor** represents the **degree of confidence or belief in a particular conclusion**.

Instead of stating that something is completely true or false, certainty factors allow the system to express **how strongly a conclusion is supported by evidence**.

This method was widely used in early expert systems such as **MYCIN (medical diagnosis system)**.

Overview

Concept	Meaning
Certainty Factor (CF)	measure of confidence in a conclusion
Belief Measure	degree to which evidence supports a hypothesis
Disbelief Measure	degree to which evidence contradicts a hypothesis
Rule-Based Systems	systems that use IF–THEN rules for reasoning

1. Concept of Certainty Factors

Meaning: A **certainty factor** is a numerical value that indicates **how certain the system is about a particular fact or conclusion**.

The certainty factor value lies between:

$-1 \leq CF \leq +1$

Where:

Value	Meaning
+1	completely true
0	unknown or neutral
-1	completely false

Interpretation of Certainty Factor

CF Value	Meaning
1.0	absolute certainty
0.8	high confidence
0.5	moderate confidence
0	no information
-0.5	moderate disbelief
-1.0	complete disbelief

Example

Rule:

IF patient has fever

THEN infection (CF = 0.7)

Meaning: The system is **70% confident** that the patient has an infection if fever is observed.

2. Rule-Based Systems with Uncertainty
Meaning : A **rule-based system** uses **IF–THEN rules** to represent knowledge and perform reasoning. However, real-world knowledge is often uncertain. Certainty factors are used to **attach confidence values to rules**.

Structure of Rule with Certainty Factor
General format:
IF condition
THEN conclusion (CF = value)

Example
Medical rule:
IF fever AND cough
THEN flu (CF = 0.8)
Meaning: If the patient has fever and cough, there is **80% confidence that the patient has flu**.

Reasoning with Multiple Rules : If several rules support the same conclusion, their certainty factors can be **combined**.
Example:
Rule 1:
IF fever
THEN infection (CF = 0.6)
Rule 2:
IF high_white_blood_cells
THEN infection (CF = 0.7)
Both rules contribute to the conclusion **infection**.

3. Belief and Disbelief Measures
Certainty factors are based on two measures:

- **Measure of Belief (MB)**
- **Measure of Disbelief (MD)**

These values indicate how strongly the evidence supports or contradicts a hypothesis.

Measure of Belief (MB)
Meaning : The **measure of belief** indicates **how strongly the evidence supports a hypothesis**.
Range: $0 \le MB \le 1$
Example: MB(infection) = 0.8
Meaning: The evidence supports infection with **80% confidence**.

Measure of Disbelief (MD)
Meaning: The **measure of disbelief** indicates **how strongly the evidence contradicts a hypothesis**.
Range: $0 \le MD \le 1$
Example: MD(infection) = 0.2
Meaning: There is **20% evidence against infection**.

Certainty Factor Formula
Certainty factor is calculated as:

$CF = MB - MD$

Where:

Symbol	Meaning
MB	measure of belief
MD	measure of disbelief
CF	certainty factor

Example

Suppose:

$MB = 0.8$

$MD = 0.2$

Then: $CF = 0.8 - 0.2 = 0.6$

The conclusion has **60% confidence**.

4. Combining Certainty Factors

When multiple pieces of evidence support the same conclusion, certainty factors must be combined.

For two positive certainty factors:

$CF_{combined} = CF1 + CF2(1 - CF1)$

Example

Rule 1: $CF1 = 0.6$

Rule 2: $CF2 = 0.5$

Combined certainty:

$CF_{combined} = 0.6 + 0.5(1 - 0.6)$

$= 0.6 + 0.2$

$= 0.8$

Final confidence becomes **0.8**.

5. Use of Certainty Factors in Expert Systems

Expert systems often work with **uncertain knowledge provided by human experts**.

Instead of exact probabilities, experts provide **confidence levels**.

Certainty factors allow the system to represent these confidence levels mathematically.

Example: MYCIN Expert System

MYCIN was a medical expert system used to diagnose bacterial infections.

Example rule:

IF organism is gram-positive

AND shape is spherical

THEN organism is streptococcus (CF = 0.7)

The system combines multiple rules to estimate the final diagnosis.

Process in Expert Systems

Patient symptoms

↓

Apply rules with CF values

↓

Combine certainty factors

↓

Generate diagnosis with confidence level

Advantages of Certainty Factors

Advantage	Explanation
simple representation	easy to assign confidence values
handles uncertainty	useful when probabilities unavailable
efficient reasoning	suitable for rule-based systems

Limitations

Limitation	Explanation
subjective values	depends on expert judgment
less mathematically rigorous	compared to probability theory
complex combination	when many rules interact

Applications of Certainty Factors

Application	Example
Medical diagnosis	disease identification
Expert systems	rule-based decision support
Fault diagnosis	equipment troubleshooting
Risk assessment	uncertain decision making

Summary

Concept	Meaning
Certainty Factor	measure of confidence in conclusion
Belief Measure	evidence supporting hypothesis
Disbelief Measure	evidence contradicting hypothesis
CF Formula	CF = MB − MD
Use	handling uncertainty in rule-based systems

Certainty factors allow AI systems to **represent uncertain expert knowledge and make decisions even when exact probabilities are not available**.

5.5 Bayesian Networks: This is a **very important probabilistic model used in modern AI and machine learning**.

Rule-Based Systems with Uncertainty : In many real-world problems, knowledge is **not completely certain**. Experts may only provide rules that are **likely to be true rather than absolutely true**. To handle this situation, AI systems use **rule-based systems with uncertainty**.

In these systems, rules are combined with **probabilities or confidence values** so that the system can perform reasoning even when information is uncertain.

This approach is commonly used in:

- expert systems
- medical diagnosis systems
- decision-support systems

Overview

Concept	Meaning
Probabilistic Rules	rules with probability values
Combining Evidence	combining multiple pieces of uncertain information
Inference with Uncertainty	deriving conclusions when knowledge is uncertain
Rule-Based Systems	systems that use IF–THEN rules

1. Rule-Based Systems
Meaning : A **rule-based system** is an AI system that represents knowledge using **rules of the form IF–THEN**.
Each rule describes a relationship between conditions and conclusions.

Basic Rule Structure
General format:
IF condition
THEN conclusion

Example
IF fever
THEN infection
This rule describes a logical relationship between symptoms and disease.
However, in real-world situations this rule may **not always be true**, so uncertainty must be considered.

2. Probabilistic Rules
Meaning: A **probabilistic rule** is a rule that includes a **probability value representing the likelihood of the conclusion**.
Instead of saying the rule is always true, the rule expresses **how likely the conclusion is**.

Structure of Probabilistic Rule
IF condition
THEN conclusion (Probability = p)
Where **p** represents the probability.

Example
Medical diagnosis rule:
IF patient has fever
THEN infection (Probability = 0.7)
Meaning: If a patient has fever, there is **70% chance that the patient has infection**.

Example in AI
Spam detection rule:
IF email contains suspicious words
THEN spam (Probability = 0.8)
The system believes with **80% probability** that the email is spam.

3. Combining Evidence
Often, multiple pieces of evidence are available for the same conclusion.
AI systems must combine this evidence to determine the **overall probability of a hypothesis**.

Example
Symptoms observed:
Fever
Cough
Fatigue
Rules:

Rule	Probability
Fever → Flu	0.6
Cough → Flu	0.5
Fatigue → Flu	0.4

The system combines these probabilities to estimate the **overall likelihood of flu**.

Evidence Combination Methods

Different methods are used to combine evidence.

Method	Description
Probability combination	combine probabilities mathematically
Certainty factors	combine confidence values
Bayesian reasoning	update belief using Bayes theorem

Example of Evidence Combination

Suppose two rules support the same conclusion.
Rule 1: IF fever THEN flu (0.6)
Rule 2: IF cough THEN flu (0.5)
Combined evidence increases the confidence that the patient has flu.

4. Inference with Uncertainty

Meaning : Inference with uncertainty means deriving conclusions when rules and facts are **not completely reliable**.
Instead of producing a definite answer, the system produces a **probability value for the conclusion**.

Reasoning Process

Facts + Probabilistic Rules
↓
Evidence Evaluation
↓
Probability Calculation
↓
Conclusion with Confidence

Example

Facts:
Patient has fever
Patient has cough
Rules:
IF fever AND cough
THEN flu (Probability = 0.8)
Conclusion: Probability(patient has flu) = 0.8
The system expresses the result as **80% confidence**.

Example: Fault Diagnosis

Facts:
Engine noise
Low oil level
Rules:

IF engine_noise → engine_problem (0.6)
IF low_oil → engine_problem (0.7)
Combined evidence increases the probability of **engine problem**.

Reasoning Using Uncertain Rules
In uncertain reasoning, the system:
1. collects facts from environment
2. applies probabilistic rules
3. calculates confidence levels
4. selects the most probable conclusion

Example: Weather Prediction
Facts:
Dark clouds
High humidity
Rules:
IF clouds THEN rain (0.6)
IF humidity THEN rain (0.5)
The system estimates the probability of rain using combined evidence.

Applications of Rule-Based Systems with Uncertainty

Application	**Example**
Medical diagnosis	disease prediction
Expert systems	decision support
Fault detection	machine troubleshooting
Risk assessment	financial prediction

Advantages

Advantage	**Explanation**
handles uncertain knowledge	useful for real-world problems
flexible reasoning	supports probabilistic rules
combines multiple evidence sources	improves decision accuracy

Limitations

Limitation	**Explanation**
complex probability calculations	difficult for large systems
rule conflicts	different rules may produce different conclusions
requires expert knowledge	probabilities must be defined

Relationship with Other Uncertainty Methods

Method	**Purpose**
Certainty factors	confidence-based reasoning
Bayesian networks	probabilistic graphical models
Fuzzy logic	handling vague information

Rule-based systems with uncertainty often combine these methods.

Summary

Concept	**Meaning**

Probabilistic Rules	rules with probability values
Combining Evidence	merging multiple uncertain facts
Inference with Uncertainty	reasoning under uncertain conditions
Rule-Based Systems	knowledge represented using IF–THEN rules

Rule-based systems with uncertainty allow AI systems to **make intelligent decisions even when knowledge is incomplete or uncertain**.

5.6 Bayesian Networks: This is one of the **most powerful probabilistic models used in modern AI systems**.

Bayesian Networks : A **Bayesian Network (BN)** is a probabilistic graphical model used in Artificial Intelligence to represent **relationships between variables and their probabilities**. It helps AI systems reason under uncertainty by combining **probability theory and graph structures**.

A Bayesian network represents variables as **nodes** and their probabilistic dependencies as **edges** in a directed graph.

These networks are widely used in:

- medical diagnosis
- machine learning
- risk analysis
- decision support systems

Overview

Concept	Meaning
Bayesian Network	graphical model representing probabilistic relationships
Nodes	variables in the model
Edges	dependency relationships between variables
Conditional Probability Table (CPT)	probability values associated with nodes
Probabilistic Inference	reasoning based on probability calculations

1. Concept of Bayesian Networks

Meaning: A **Bayesian network** is a **directed acyclic graph (DAG)** that represents a set of variables and the probabilistic relationships between them.

The network shows **how the probability of one variable depends on other variables**.

Structure

A Bayesian network consists of:

1. **Nodes** – represent random variables
2. **Directed edges** – represent dependencies
3. **Probability tables** – describe probability relationships

Example

Weather model: Cloudy → Rain → WetGrass

Meaning:

- cloudy weather increases probability of rain
- rain increases probability of wet grass

This network represents **causal relationships between variables**.

2. Basic Terms Related to Bayesian Networks

Several terms are important for understanding Bayesian networks.

Term	Meaning
Random Variable	uncertain variable in the model
Node	graphical representation of a variable
Parent Node	node influencing another node
Child Node	node influenced by parent node
Conditional Probability	probability of event given another event

Random Variable

A **random variable** represents an uncertain quantity.

Example variables:

- Rain
- Cloudy
- Traffic
- Disease

Each variable has a **probability distribution**.

Parent and Child Nodes

If a variable influences another variable, it becomes the **parent node**.

Example: Cloudy → Rain

Here:

Node	Role
Cloudy	parent node
Rain	child node

3. Nodes and Edges

Nodes : Nodes represent **random variables**.

Examples:

Node	Meaning
Cloudy	whether sky is cloudy
Rain	whether rain occurs
WetGrass	whether grass becomes wet

Edges : Edges represent **causal relationships or dependencies** between variables.

Example network:

Cloudy
↓
Rain
↓
WetGrass

Edges indicate that:

- rain depends on cloudy conditions
- wet grass depends on rain

Directed Acyclic Graph (DAG)

A Bayesian network must be a **Directed Acyclic Graph**, meaning:

- edges have direction
- no cycles exist in the graph

Example of valid structure: A → B → C

Invalid structure: A → B → C → A
This creates a cycle, which is not allowed.

4. Conditional Probability Tables (CPT)
Meaning : Each node in a Bayesian network has a **Conditional Probability Table (CPT)**.
The CPT specifies the **probability of the node given its parent nodes**.

Example
Node: Rain
Parent: Cloudy
Conditional probability table:

Cloudy	P(Rain = True)	P(Rain = False)
True	0.8	0.2
False	0.2	0.8

Meaning:
- if cloudy, rain is likely (80%)
- if not cloudy, rain is less likely (20%)

Example: Wet Grass CPT
Parents:
Rain
Sprinkler
Conditional probability table:

Rain	Sprinkler	P(WetGrass)
True	True	0.99
True	False	0.9
False	True	0.8
False	False	0.0

This table describes the probability of wet grass depending on rain and sprinkler.

5. Probabilistic Inference
Meaning : Probabilistic inference is the process of **calculating the probability of unknown variables given observed evidence**.
In Bayesian networks, inference allows the system to **update probabilities when new information is observed**.

Example
Network: Cloudy → Rain → WetGrass
Observed evidence: WetGrass = True
Question: What is probability that it rained?
The system calculates: P(Rain | WetGrass)
This is called **probabilistic inference**.

Types of Inference

Type	Description
Predictive inference	cause → effect
Diagnostic inference	effect → cause
Intercausal inference	interaction between causes

Example: Medical Diagnosis
Network: Disease → Symptom
Observed evidence: Patient has symptom
Inference: P(Disease | Symptom)
The system estimates the probability of disease.

Example Bayesian Network Structure

```
Cloudy
 ↓
Rain     Sprinkler
  ↓        ↓
    WetGrass
```

Relationships:

- cloudy affects rain and sprinkler
- rain and sprinkler affect wet grass

This network captures the **probabilistic relationships between variables.**

Advantages of Bayesian Networks

Advantage	Explanation
handles uncertainty	uses probability
compact representation	efficient knowledge modeling
supports inference	update beliefs with evidence
interpretable model	graphical structure easy to understand

Limitations

Limitation	Explanation
complex networks	difficult for many variables
probability estimation	requires accurate probability values
computational cost	inference may be expensive

Applications of Bayesian Networks

Application	Example
Medical diagnosis	disease prediction
Machine learning	probabilistic models
Fault diagnosis	system failure analysis
Decision support systems	risk assessment

Summary

Concept	Meaning
Bayesian Network	probabilistic graphical model
Nodes	random variables
Edges	dependency relationships
CPT	probability tables for nodes
Probabilistic Inference	reasoning using probability

Bayesian networks provide a powerful framework for **representing probabilistic relationships and performing reasoning under uncertainty in AI systems**.

Dempster–Shafer Theory : This topic explains another method for **handling uncertainty and combining evidence in AI systems**.

Dempster–Shafer Theory : Dempster–Shafer Theory (DST) is a mathematical framework used in Artificial Intelligence for **reasoning under uncertainty and combining evidence from different sources**.

It is considered an **alternative to traditional probability theory** because it allows the system to represent **partial knowledge and uncertainty more flexibly**.

Unlike probability theory, where probabilities must be assigned to individual events, Dempster–Shafer theory allows assigning **belief to sets of possibilities**.

It is commonly used in:

- expert systems
- sensor fusion systems
- decision support systems
- risk analysis

Overview

Concept	Meaning
Dempster–Shafer Theory	method for reasoning with uncertain evidence
Belief Function	measure of confidence supporting a hypothesis
Plausibility Function	measure of how possible a hypothesis is
Evidence Combination	combining evidence from multiple sources

1. Concept of Dempster–Shafer Theory

Meaning : Dempster–Shafer Theory provides a method to **represent uncertainty without requiring exact probabilities**.

Instead of assigning probability directly to a single event, it assigns **belief to groups of events**.

This allows the system to represent **lack of knowledge explicitly**.

Key Idea

Traditional probability: P(event)

Dempster–Shafer theory:

Belief(event)

Plausibility(event)

These values represent **ranges of confidence rather than exact probabilities**.

Example

Suppose we want to diagnose a disease.

Possible diseases: {Flu, Cold, Allergy}

Evidence may suggest: {Flu OR Cold}

Instead of assigning exact probability to each disease, the system assigns belief to **a set of possibilities**.

Frame of Discernment

In Dempster–Shafer theory, the set of all possible hypotheses is called the **frame of discernment**.

Representation: Θ

Example: Θ = {Flu, Cold, Allergy}

All possible outcomes belong to this set.

2. Belief Function

Meaning : The **belief function** represents the **degree of confidence that the available evidence supports a hypothesis**.
It indicates the **minimum amount of support** for a hypothesis.

Representation
Bel(A)Where **A** is a hypothesis.
Range: $0 \le Bel(A) \le 1$

Example
Evidence:
Symptom: fever
Belief values:

Disease	Belief
Flu	0.6
Cold	0.2

This means:

- evidence supports flu with 60% belief
- evidence supports cold with 20% belief

Properties of Belief Function

Property	Explanation
Bel(∅) = 0	empty set has no belief
Bel(Θ) = 1	total belief equals 1
Bel(A) ≤ Bel(B)	if A ⊆ B

3. Plausibility Function
Meaning : The **plausibility function** represents the **maximum possible belief that could support a hypothesis**.
It measures **how plausible a hypothesis is given the available evidence**.

Representation : Pl(A)
Range: $0 \le Pl(A) \le 1$

Relationship Between Belief and Plausibility
$Bel(A) \le Pl(A)$
Meaning:

- belief represents **confirmed support**
- plausibility represents **possible support**

Example : Disease diagnosis.
Evidence: Symptoms: fever, cough
Belief:
Bel(Flu) = 0.5
Plausibility:
Pl(Flu) = 0.8
Interpretation:

- confirmed support = 0.5
- maximum possible support = 0.8

Belief Interval
The interval between belief and plausibility represents **uncertainty**.
Bel(A) ≤ Probability(A) ≤ Pl(A)
Example:
0.5 ≤ P(Flu) ≤ 0.8
This shows the range of possible probability values.

4. Evidence Combination
One of the key features of Dempster–Shafer theory is the ability to **combine evidence from multiple sources**.
This is done using **Dempster's Rule of Combination**.

Dempster's Rule
If two independent sources provide evidence:
m1(A)
m2(A)
Then the combined evidence is calculated using Dempster's combination rule.
The rule merges evidence while considering **conflicts between sources**.

Example
Sensor 1:

Hypothesis	Belief
Target is vehicle	0.6

Sensor 2:

Hypothesis	Belief
Target is vehicle	0.7

Combining both sources increases confidence that the object is a vehicle.

Evidence Combination Process
Evidence Source 1
↓
Evidence Source 2
↓
Dempster Combination Rule
↓
Combined Belief
This produces a more reliable conclusion.

Example: Fault Diagnosis
Evidence sources:
Sensor A
Sensor B
Sensor A indicates fault with belief: 0.6
Sensor B indicates fault with belief: 0.7
Combining evidence increases confidence that a fault exists.

Comparison with Probability Theory

Feature	Probability Theory	Dempster–Shafer Theory
representation	exact probability	belief intervals

uncertainty	limited handling	explicit uncertainty
knowledge requirement	precise probabilities required	allows incomplete knowledge

Advantages of Dempster–Shafer Theory

Advantage	Explanation
handles incomplete information	no need for exact probabilities
flexible representation	belief ranges instead of fixed values
combines multiple evidence sources	improves reliability

Limitations

Limitation	Explanation
computational complexity	difficult for large systems
evidence conflict	conflicting evidence may create problems
less widely used	compared to Bayesian methods

Applications in AI

Application	Example
sensor fusion	combining data from sensors
expert systems	uncertain decision making
fault detection	system diagnosis
pattern recognition	object classification

Summary

Concept	Meaning
Dempster–Shafer Theory	reasoning under uncertainty
Belief Function	degree of confirmed support
Plausibility Function	maximum possible support
Evidence Combination	merging evidence from sources

Dempster–Shafer theory provides a powerful method for **representing uncertainty and combining evidence when exact probabilities are difficult to determine**.

5.8 Fuzzy Logic

This topic explains how AI systems handle **vague or imprecise information using fuzzy sets and membership functions.**

Fuzzy Logic : Fuzzy Logic is a method used in Artificial Intelligence to handle **vague, imprecise, or uncertain information**. Unlike classical logic (which only uses **true or false values**), fuzzy logic allows **degrees of truth**.

This makes fuzzy logic very useful in real-world situations where concepts are **not strictly defined**, such as:

- temperature (hot, warm, cold)
- speed (fast, slow)
- height (tall, short)

Fuzzy logic allows AI systems to represent these **gradual concepts mathematically**.

It is widely used in:

- control systems
- consumer electronics
- robotics
- decision support systems

Overview

Concept	Meaning
Fuzzy Set	set with gradual membership
Membership Function	function describing degree of membership
Fuzzy Rules	IF–THEN rules using fuzzy logic
Fuzzy Inference System	system that performs reasoning using fuzzy logic

1. Fuzzy Sets

Meaning : A **fuzzy set** is a set in which elements can belong **partially rather than completely**.

In classical sets:

Element ∈ Set → True or False

In fuzzy sets:

Membership value between 0 and 1

This value represents **degree of belonging**.

Example

Set: **Hot Temperature**

Temperature values:

Temperature	Membership in "Hot"
20°C	0.1
30°C	0.5
40°C	0.9

This means:

- 20°C is slightly hot
- 30°C is moderately hot
- 40°C is strongly hot

Classical vs Fuzzy Set

Feature	Classical Set	Fuzzy Set
Membership	0 or 1	between 0 and 1
Boundaries	sharp	gradual
Example	tall or not tall	somewhat tall

Example

Height classification:

Classical logic: Height ≥ 180 cm → Tall

Fuzzy logic:

Height	Tall Membership
170 cm	0.3
180 cm	0.6
190 cm	0.9

2. Membership Functions

Meaning: A **membership function** defines how each element in a fuzzy set is assigned a **membership value between 0 and 1**.

It describes **how strongly an element belongs to a fuzzy set**.

Mathematical Representation

Membership function:

µA(x)

Where:

- **A** = fuzzy set
- **x** = element
- **µA(x)** = membership value

Example

Fuzzy set: **Warm Temperature**

Temperature	µWarm
15°C	0.2
25°C	0.7
35°C	0.4

Types of Membership Functions

Type	Description
Triangular	simple triangular shape
Trapezoidal	flat top trapezoid
Gaussian	bell-shaped curve
Sigmoid	smooth S-shaped curve

These functions define how membership values change.

Example: Triangular Membership

```
      1
     /\
    /  \
   /    \
0--/--------\---- Temperature
```

Membership increases and then decreases gradually.

3. Fuzzy Rules

Meaning : Fuzzy rules are **IF–THEN rules that use fuzzy concepts rather than precise values**.

They are used to represent expert knowledge.

Rule Structure

IF condition

THEN conclusion

Both conditions and conclusions are fuzzy concepts.

Example

Temperature control system.

IF temperature is HIGH

THEN fan speed is FAST

Another rule:

IF temperature is MEDIUM

THEN fan speed is MODERATE

These rules allow the system to handle gradual changes.

Example Rule Set

Rule	Description
IF temperature is low	heater power high
IF temperature is medium	heater power medium
IF temperature is high	heater power low

4. Fuzzy Inference Systems

Meaning : A **Fuzzy Inference System (FIS)** is a system that uses fuzzy logic to **map inputs to outputs using fuzzy rules**.

It performs reasoning based on fuzzy sets and rules.

Components of Fuzzy Inference System

Component	Function
Fuzzification	convert crisp inputs into fuzzy values
Rule Base	collection of fuzzy rules
Inference Engine	applies fuzzy reasoning
Defuzzification	convert fuzzy output to crisp value

Working Process

Input Data
↓
Fuzzification
↓
Rule Evaluation
↓
Inference Engine
↓
Defuzzification
↓
Final Output

Example: Temperature Control

Input:
Temperature = 30°C
Fuzzification:
Warm = 0.7
Hot = 0.3
Rules applied:
IF temperature is warm → fan speed medium
IF temperature is hot → fan speed high
Output calculated and converted to actual fan speed.

Defuzzification

After fuzzy reasoning, the result must be converted into a **crisp numerical output**.

Common methods:

Method	Description
Centroid method	most common technique
Mean of maxima	average of highest values

Weighted average	weighted calculation

Handling Vague and Imprecise Information

Fuzzy logic is useful for representing concepts that **do not have precise boundaries**.
Examples:

Concept	Example
Temperature	hot, warm, cold
Speed	slow, medium, fast
Age	young, middle-aged, old

Traditional logic cannot represent these gradual concepts effectively.

Real-World Applications

Application	Example
Washing machines	automatic wash control
Air conditioners	temperature control
Cameras	autofocus systems
Traffic control	intelligent traffic signals

Advantages of Fuzzy Logic

Advantage	Explanation
handles vague concepts	human-like reasoning
simple rule representation	easy to implement
robust control systems	stable performance

Limitations

Limitation	Explanation
subjective membership functions	depends on expert design
not precise for all problems	limited mathematical accuracy
rule explosion	too many rules for complex systems

Comparison: Classical Logic vs Fuzzy Logic

Feature	Classical Logic	Fuzzy Logic
Truth values	0 or 1	between 0 and 1
boundaries	strict	gradual
reasoning	exact	approximate

Summary

Concept	Meaning
Fuzzy Set	set with partial membership
Membership Function	defines degree of membership
Fuzzy Rules	IF–THEN rules with fuzzy terms
Fuzzy Inference System	system performing fuzzy reasoning

Fuzzy logic allows AI systems to **model human reasoning and handle vague or imprecise information effectively**.